

Harsimran Sidhu

SECURITY OPERATIONS | INCIDENT RESPONSE | THREAT INTELLIGENCE

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Security operations analyst with 4+ years of experience across SOC and IT infrastructure. Investigates endpoint, identity, web, email, and network threats; builds detection logic and automation; and turns technical evidence into clear response decisions. Publishes practical SOC playbooks and threat research grounded in real investigation workflows.

EXPERIENCE

Security Operations Center Analyst

Nov 2022 - Present

Columba System Inc | Remote

- Investigate endpoint, web, identity, and email-security alerts to validate threats, scope impact, and determine the appropriate response.
- Build and tune Splunk rules and alerts that support threat detection, triage, and repeatable investigation workflows.
- Correlate Cortex XDR, WAF, authentication, URL, and email-header evidence to separate malicious activity from false positives.
- Manage Jira cases from initial triage through documentation and escalation, preserving clear evidence and decision context for IT teams.
- Automate compliance checks and URL-verification tasks with custom scripts to reduce repetitive analyst work.

Cyber Security Analyst

Oct 2021 - Nov 2022

SecureOps | Remote

- Investigated and escalated incidents across Microsoft 365 Defender, Splunk, and Microsoft Sentinel within defined service agreements.
- Wrote Kusto Query Language queries to filter security telemetry, validate alert context, and support incident scoping.
- Analyzed network traffic with Wireshark and used an AWS sandbox to examine suspicious activity safely.
- Produced clear investigation updates and coordinated response decisions with distributed technical teams.

Information Technology Specialist

Jan 2021 - Aug 2021

Telecom Metrics Inc | Kingston, Ontario

- Led security and infrastructure projects supporting server maintenance, reliability, and operational continuity.
- Implemented high-availability solutions and Python automation for recurring operational tasks.
- Delivered remote troubleshooting and technical support across infrastructure and end-user systems.

CORE CAPABILITIES

Security Operations Detection and Analysis Platforms Automation and Engineering

Alert triage, incident response, threat hunting, endpoint security, WAF analysis, email security, IOC enrichment, log correlation
Detection engineering, Splunk rules, KQL, packet analysis, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, technical documentation
Cortex XDR, Splunk, Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Sentinel, AWS Sandbox, Jira, Wireshark
Python, Bash/Shell, Git, GitHub, Docker, Azure, CI/CD

SELECTED SECURITY WORK

Web and Identity Incident Response: Published hands-on playbooks for WordPress compromise and WAF login attacks, covering triage, evidence preservation, log analysis, scoping, containment, and hardening.

Threat Research: Analyzed Qilin ransomware, the XZ supply-chain backdoor, and Cortex XDR abuse patterns with attack timelines and defensive recommendations.

Security Engineering and Automation: Built Python website monitoring, Docker-based network protection, and GitHub/Azure CI/CD projects documented for other practitioners.

EDUCATION

Cyber Security

University of Toronto Continuing Education |
Toronto, ON
Jan 2020 - Aug 2020

Bachelor of Engineering in Technology

Cape Breton University | Sydney, NS
Sept 2017 - Apr 2019

Electromechanical Engineering - Advanced Diploma

Humber College | Toronto, ON
Sept 2013 - Apr 2016